



Chinmaya Sakshi



Chinmaya International Residential School KHEL MELA 2008 ISSUE

Insight2, pulse 5
February 2008

Hari Om,

The word "Khel", does not only mean a sport, but a sport full of fun and joy. Unfortunately today a sport is played mainly to win. The winner is joyful and the one who does not win is sad.

True sportsmanship is when we play the game to the best of our capacity, enjoying every moment, expressing beyond our limit one's physical, emotional and intellectual abilities. Then the trophy is just a bonus. We welcome all our parents, relatives and guardians of our children to enjoy this fun filled *mela*-fair that Gurudev envisioned for the holistic growth of our children.

- Pujaya Swami Swaroopananda



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From the Editorial Team



Hari Om,

Happy New Year to all of you, and may 2008 be as good a year as any! We at the school greatly enjoyed our one-month winter holidays as an opportunity to reunite with our family and friends back home. Some of us took the opportunity during the holidays to make presentations on our school and spread the knowledge that such an institution exists. Now we are back with our second family, the CIRS family. We have arrived back at the campus with a busy month ahead.

This month's newsletter has been dubbed the “Khel Mela Edition”, and with good reason too. The hustle and bustle that takes place in preparation and anticipation of the Annual Sports Day celebrations are memorable. It revamps the whole month of January at our school, transforming this seemingly dull month into a lively, hectic 30-day period humming with activity. Parents from all corners of the world will converge at this point, and as we put up a fine display of sorts, we want all to know that all the hard work put into this task did pay off.

To cover all the emotions and excitement felt by the students over the celebration is not a task that can be disclosed through writing. However, January is not the only month of sports. It is also a month wherein we celebrate the day of Pongal. The 16th of January is a very auspicious day, being the day that the great master, Shri Param Pujya Gurudev Swami Tapovan Maharaj attained mahasamadhi. By no means is January the month of Khel Mela preparations, but since all the energy, intensity and enthusiasm regarding the event fills the month of January, January just got a whole lot more interesting.

With regards,

Gautam Pathial, Shruti Kedia, Vishwanth Kumar, and Savi Kerkar
The Cultural and Literary Secretaries

Associates: Saurabh Bhandari and Tanuj Agarwal

Faculty members: Smt. Uma M., Smt. Geetha A., Smt. Sunanda K. C., Sri Ravi Kumar R

Assistance: Sri Sundar Gandikota

Chinmaya International Residential School



PROGRAMME

06.02.08 - 07.02.08



Wednesday, February 6, 2008

2:00 pm	Welcome – CIRS Gates open after Lunch	
2:30 pm	Assemble in front of School Block	
2:45 pm	Flag Hoisting	
Upto 6.00 pm	Games and sports of staff vs parents, students vs parents; tea	Arjuna - Athletic grounds
6.30 pm	Talk by Pujya Swami Swaroopananda – Director in Charge	Gokul – Multipurpose Hall
7.45 pm	Dinner	Arjuna - Athletic grounds
9.30 pm	CIRS Gates close	

Thursday, February 7, 2008

6.45 am	CIRS Gates open before Breakfast	
7.15 am	Arrival of Chief Guest – R.NATARAJAN Superintendent of Customs, CUSTOMS DEPARTMENT, Chennai Dr. K. VAITHIANATHAN, Professor & Director, Dept. of Phy. Edu. & Sports Sciences, Annamalai University. And Field Events starts...	Arjuna - Athletic grounds
Upto 8.30 am	Breakfast	Arjuna - Athletic grounds
Upto 1.00 pm	Sporting events continue	Arjuna - Athletic grounds
1.00 pm	Lunch	Arjuna - Athletic grounds
Upto 2.30 pm	Rest in dorm of your ward	
2.30 pm to 6.00 pm	Displays and Closing Ceremony ; Tea	Arjuna - Athletic grounds
6.30 pm	CIRS Gates open for departure	

Sunday, February 10, 2008

All the students must return by 7:30 pm

Teacher Learning Program

Workshop for Teachers



CIRS is a learning institution. The teachers, RHPs and House Mothers arrive a few days prior to the start of every academic session for participating in the Teacher Learning Program. 4th January was a day of intensive learning. Teachers were presented a few leading questions based on which an introspective workshop/self awareness building exercise was conducted. The themes for the day were as follows.

What is there for experienced and competent people to learn?
Changing implications of management and managing.
How to make dorm life more creative for the students and ourselves?

In the afternoon all the participants watched the film “12 Angry Men,” directed by Sidney Lumet, followed by a discussion. The film was also shown to some sections of the students as part of the classes and was well appreciated. The film is considered to be of immense educational value for both adults and children. CIRS recommends the film to its parents too!

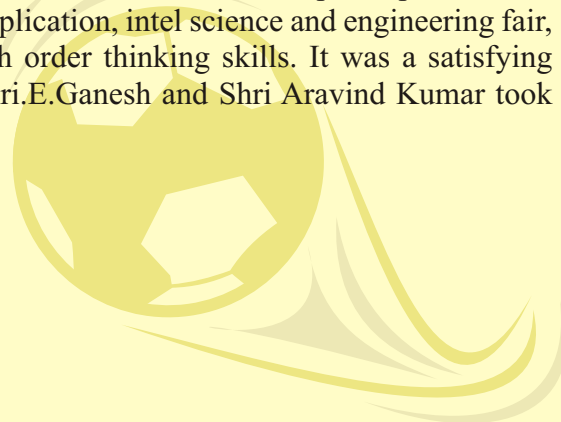
4th Jan was devoted for academic planning and detailing. Different faculty groups met to finalize their departmental priorities and plans. Some of the teachers made preparations for their classes, including preparing teaching materials.

Enrichment In Chemistry

Workshop for Teachers



A Workshop was organised by CIRS, chemistry department on “ Enrichment in Chemistry” on 24th January, 2008. 16 teachers of Chinmaya Vidyalayas and schools from Coimbatore participated in the workshop. The workshop dealt with mind mapping and its application, intel science and engineering fair, its uses in teaching learning process and developing high order thinking skills. It was a satisfying experience. Shri V.Sudarsan was the workshop leader . Shri.E.Ganesh and Shri Aravind Kumar took active role in organising various sessions.



An Exemplary Youth!!

Swami Vivekananda Jayanthi



Swami Vivekananda, whose pre-monastic name was **Narendranath Dutta**, was one of the most famous and influential spiritual leaders of modern times. He preached the philosophies of Vedanta in a lucid, logical style, appealing to the rational thinker. He was the chief disciple of the renowned Ramakrishna Paramahansa and the founder of Ramakrishna Math and Ramakrishna Mission. He is a major figure in the history of the Hindu reform movements.

Vivekananda was the first known Hindu sage to come to the West, where he introduced Eastern thought at the World's Parliament of Religions, in connection with the World Fair in Chicago, in 1893. Here, his first lecture, which started this very line "Sisters and Brothers of America," made the audience clap for two minutes just to the address, for prior to this seminal speech, the audience was always used to this opening address: "Ladies and Gentlemen". It was this speech that catapulted him to fame by his wide audiences in Chicago and then later everywhere else in America, including far-flung places such as Memphis, Boston, San Francisco, New York, Los Angeles, and St. Louis.

This great sage was saluted by CIRS on his jayanthi. Our young members comprising of 7th and 8th grade had an interhouse elocution competition in his honour. The judges were in a turmoil when they had to decide on a winner. Alas! Some one had to win and some one had to loose. The decision was that the first prize went to Manish P. of Vasishtha House, second and third went to Umang and Rajshree of Vyasa House. It was an interesting, fulfilling, enlightening evening.



Pongolo pongal!

Pongal Festival



Pongal is a harvest festival equivalent to Thanksgiving celebrated by Tamilians across the world. *Pongal* in Tamil means "boiling over or spill over." When the water in the clay pot boils over, it is considered to denote future prosperity for the family.

Traditionally celebrated at harvest time, it is a celebration of the prosperity associated with the harvest by thanking the rain, sun and the farm animals that have helped in the harvest.

In CIRS, we followed the traditional way of celebrating Pongal. The CIRS family was divided into various groups and they celebrated Pongal early in the morning by boiling rice with water and jaggery in new clay pots, which were later topped with cashew nuts and raisins and allowing it to boil over the vessel. This tradition gives Pongal its name. The moment the rice boils over and bubbles out of the vessel, the tradition is to shout of "*Pongolo Pongal!*" and blow the *sangu* (a conch), and a custom practiced during the festival is to announce it is going to be a year blessed with good tidings. Then new boiled rice is offered to the Nature during sunrise, a gesture which symbolizes thanks to the sun and Nature for providing prosperity. It is later served to all the people present in the school. Later, in the evening we all flew kites, as it is a tradition followed in the state of Gujrat.

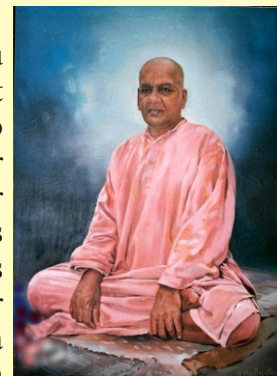


Saluting the Source

Swami Tapovan Samadhi Day



Swami Chinmayananda admitted that he could not adequately describe his Guru using mere words as a means of expression, since there was so much which could not be explained about him. He was no mere man, no mere mortal figure in history who came into existence and then vanished later on. He represents the ever-present factor of life, the common denominator that never goes away, the opposite of all the other temporary facets of life that have no meaning in the end. When a realized soul attains mahasamadhi, it is celebrated as an auspicious day since the individual soul is uniting with the whole again. In this manner, we celebrated the samadhi of our Gurudev's Gurudev, Shri Param Pujya Gurudev Swami Tapovan Maharaj. We had a puja in the morning, during which we were shown a presentation on Tapovan Maharaj. Our own Swami Swaroopanandaji, who was present at the puja, expressed on how the very image of this great master can invoke such a respectful silence. Classes resumed after that in the usual manner, and in the evening, we had a special Aarti dedicated to Him.



IB DIPLOMA

Results, November 2007



The students of IB batch 2006-2007 took their final exam in November 2007. The following are the highlights of the IB result:

Number of students with Diploma	13 out of 15
Highest total score achieved	40 out of 45
Number of students with highest individual subject score of 7	9 out of 15

The IB result of November 2007 is an improvement over the previous session results in many aspects. The school average grade for most subjects is more than the world average.

The IB diploma programme is student oriented and emphasizes more on participatory learning experiences of the students.

At CIRS, the focus areas of improvement in the IB diploma programme for the forthcoming years shall be as follows:

- Extended Essay: Improvement in the quality of the investigation and the presentation of Extended essay.
- Theory of Knowledge: Strengthening of the TOK component of individual subjects.
- Information and Communication Technology (ICT): Implementation of the ICT techniques in science investigations. ICT techniques include data logging, use of graph plotting software, use of spreadsheets / database, computer modeling / simulation.
- IB results: Enabling more students to achieve a total score of 40+.

The Number Game !!

Mathematics Week



Our school emphasizes the importance of every subject by dedicating one week to each department. Mathematics is one such subject without which life wouldn't be fun.

The math week was celebrated from the 21st of January to the 25th of January.

The math week was full of fun and interesting activities. The week started with the topic of "Applications of Mathematics" in our daily life. This topic was really startling as this was something none of us were aware of.



Knowing the history of something develops an eagerness to know more about the subject. We had a presentation on the history of mathematics which developed a strong base about that subject amongst the teachers as well as students to encourage them to take interest in mathematics.

Recently, there has been a talk about a branch of mathematics called "Vedic Mathematics". What exactly is this Vedic mathematics? Vedic mathematics is a branch of mathematics which deals with the fast and simple methods of calculating lengthy math problems "orally". Vedic mathematics consists of *shlokas*. Each shloka deals with the fast and mental calculations of sums. Vedic mathematics definitely got all of us interested and taught us a new approach.



Ratios and proportions is one branch of mathematics which students think is tough and confusing. Mathematics has a technique to make everything easy and interesting. *Golden ratio* or *the divine proportion* is one such interesting topic. The golden ratio is equivalent to "1.6". This divine proportion is very special as this ratio can be seen in everything that we use and experience in our daily life. This ratio can be seen in our palm measuring from the tip of our middle finger to the end of the palm and it can even be seen while measuring the length of the face from the top of the forehead

to the nose and the whole length of the face. This divine proportion theory opened the window to a new and interesting dimension in the field of mathematics.

Planet Earth is very beautiful and colorful but nature is nothing but dimensions. Fractals is another field of mathematics which was explained in detail by the Mathematics Department. Nature is a mixture of all the geometrical figures. For example, when lines are assembled at certain angles, a beautiful tree is formed.



A junior mathematics quiz was also conducted in the Amphitheatre of our school. This was the first quiz to take place in the Amphitheatre. All the students and teachers were eagerly looking forward to it. The competition was fun and at the same time filled with information. It opened the gates of our mind and made us aware of the fact that mathematics can be fun and enjoyment.

Saluting Our Nation

Republic Day



26th January, 1950 is one of the most important days in Indian history as it was on this day the constitution of India came into force and India became a truly sovereign state. On this day India became a completely republican nation. On this day, our country salutes the dream of Mahatma Gandhi and the numerous freedom fighters who, fought for and sacrificed their lives for the Independence of their country.

The Republic Day is celebrated with great enthusiasm all over the country. CIRS paid its respect with a flag hoisting ceremony, followed by marchpast. On this day, Swamiji made us aware about the dangers of corruption and how it can destroy our country, if no measures are taken. We enjoyed the patriotic songs by our school choir and rejoiced in our country's glories.



Exam Fever!!!

Exams For Senior School



Our 9th and 11th graders finished their finals on 25th January. After a year of hard work, the time finally came when they had to appear for their exams. The whole of the 9th and 11th graders are now part of the 10th and 12th grades. As their exams were going on, the present 10th and 12th graders also appeared for their second pre-board in preparation for the actual board exams soon to come.

Light..action.camera!!!

Film Club In CIRS



The film club at CIRS was started in 2006 as a club activity and later on went on to screen films on the weekends.

Children today watch movies which are meant for pure entertainment and leisure. They can be a distraction and diversion from reality and desensitizes their mind. The objective of the film club is to expose children to films that are not the usual major Hollywood productions. These films from various countries and languages have a theme and are made by directors who consider cinema as an art form rather than for entertainment. The film club has been successful in evoking the thoughts of many students and making them sensitive to the issues of the world.

Here is a brief summary of the films that were screened at CIRS for the year 2007-08

Life is Beautiful (Italy / Italian): The movie is based on a family surviving the holocaust in WWII

A Beautiful Mind (US / English): It brought out the Experiences of Nobel Laureate Dr. John Nash (Mathematician)

The Insider (US / English) : The intricacies involved in the working of a tobacco company in U.S.

The Odessa File (UK / English) : A classic film that encased the Nazi Secret Service

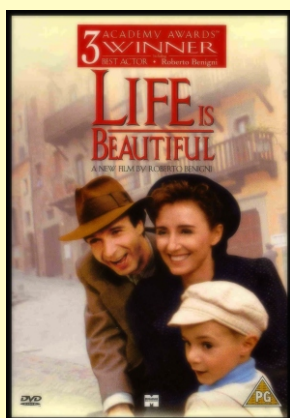
The Pursuit of Happiness (US / English) : A film on how a father tried to hold his family together during hard times.

The World's Fastest Indian (Australian / English) : A story of a man's victory over machine.

Rabbit Proof Fence (Australian / English) : A film enjoyed by junior school on the aborigines and ethnic cleansing.

Little Miss Sunshine (US / English) : The story revolved around a dysfunctional family and their journey together to win a beauty pageant.

The Last King of Scotland (US / English) : This Movie portrayed the Ugandan dictator Idi Amin



OVERVIEW ON CIRS



During the December vacations, some of us from the school were still working to spread the message; the message that tells everyone how great our institution really is and why it has people working around the clock to spread its goodness. I personally made it my goal to talk to many different centers run by the Chinmaya Mission in the U.S., letting them know about the Mission's school and how well it was doing. Using a combination of presentations given by the school and presentations I had made revolving around my personal experiences, I was able to penetrate audiences all around America and let them know how I really felt about my school. I stopped by many centers all over, resulting in a grand finale where I spoke in front of over 500 people in the Chinmaya Mission camp in Orlando, Florida, and in front of many of the Mission's respected Swamijis, including our Pujya Guruji Himself and the current head of the Chinmaya Mission, Swami Tejomayananda. I received hearty applause at the end, but my satisfaction lay more in the fact that I was willing to spread the great things my school has given me.

However, I was not the only one acting as a missionary for our school. Our dearest Principal, Mr. Anurag Sangal and his wife Mrs. Anuradha Sangal were also on a mission to speak about our school to as many people as possible. They started from Botswana, South Africa, then hopped from there to many places in South Africa, and from there, they flew to Dubai and Sharjah, speaking in both places as well. From there, Mr. Anurag Sangal flew alone to Kolkata also, (Mrs. Anuradha Sangal was sick, and thus unable to make it). While flying to all these places on behalf of the school, our dearest Principal was a big hit, and he received offers to come and talk at various other places as well invitations

One point to note was that all these events, whether Mr. Sangal's or mine, were organized by the devoted parents of CIRS families. My mother, Subha Pathial, worked hard to make sure I spoke to as many Mission centers as possible, and parents from all over were there to organize Mr. Sangal's events and ensure that this spreading of the message went as smoothly as possible. All of us who were working hard to spread the message of the school and make sure it stays as good as it was before, must be commemorated on this occasion. May many more feel inspired to do the same thing in the future.

-Gautam Pathial



Valmiki Speaks !!!



We perceive the goal through our all-seeing Eye; that of a tiger, and we hope to continue our remarkable tradition of victory. We wish to stand at the apex of success, proud of our unity unbound courage, unsurpassable excellence and focused discipline having great love and respect for each unique and irreplaceable member of the house. However, our eyes do not grant us just sight. Our opponents stiffen when they look into them, startled and intimidated by our true strength which they see in our unwavering souls. After all, the eyes are the windows to the soul and every Valmikian shares theirs with a tiger.



The fever rises as we approach the dawn of the Sports day. Our confidence in our ability as well as our consistent hard work touched with an incomparable faith completely overshadows our tenseness and the uneasy nervous feelings that may display reveal. Our drill captures this in perfection as each individual has to work diligently or they would disrupt the performance of another. It is, however completely obvious that our preparation will reap their rightful results, as the indomitable Valmikians emerge in a mile-long team smile.

Vamiki has provided evidence of its long-standing and indisputable place at the zenith having won majority of the house championships in the past. In this manner Valmiki will continue to dominate in a blaze of glory that will never end amidst a sun that will never set.

Vishwamitra Speaks !!!



A fierce and elegant eagle, soaring through cloudy night skies and bright days, soaring through life, has been the symbol of the Viswamitra house since 2005.

Similarly, its students, from grade 5 to 12 are gracefully fighting their way to the top position in this year's Khel Mela. Bringing a whole new theme to drills which CIRS has never seen before, the green house introduces, the 'fight drill', with a series of exercises that are creatively presented as a fight sequence between two armies.

Adding to this, the students will majestically present a

completely new set of pyramids and gymnastics. And to finish off our staged war, the house brings together everyone for a concluding formation.

As for the other events, the house is 'marching' towards perfection, getting closer to victory everyday.

Vasishtha Speaks !!!



Represented by a lion, the colour of the Vasishtha House is red. Unbeaten champion in the march past event on sports day, the Vasishtha House, was the first house to cross the 1000 points mark in the school history. Having the strength of only 88 students currently, we still remain a for huge competitors for all the other houses.

This year, the Vasishtha House has chosen pompoms (for girls) and poles (for boys) as our house drill. In athletic events, the Vasishtha House participants have exceeded the expectations and set records which are still unbeaten. A house truly very unique, our individual house drills in the past have included pyramids,

umbrellas and leziiums. Just like the lion, our house symbolizes strength and determination, never giving up and a readiness to break new challenges and emerge victorious. The Vasishtha House, truly, is a house with a difference.

Vyasa Speaks !!!



As the 12th Annual Athletic Meet approaches, the blue dragon is breathing fire. Things are heating up and the Vyasa House has meticulously planned its drill. Adopting a unique drill, Vyasa House has accepted the challenge of working on something never seen before. With junior and senior school cooperation, Vyasa would be using hoops as their tools to success. They would slowly exercise their way into a formation depicting “VYASA”. Now, it would be time to reveal the final item- the bamboo dance; a dance which needs excellent eye and hand coordination. Dressed in leaves the Vyasa House students would perform this jungle dance .



We have been working around the clock to improve on our march past. It is improving gradually and we are hoping to get a reward for our hard work.

Winning is difficult, but not impossible and this is the hope that keeps us striving for the impossible. After all, the sky is the limit.

SPORTS ACHIEVERS OF CIRS



Soccer Team: Prakash Coach heads the talented team, and a few of the team members have reached the National level, as well as Tamil Nadu state level. This team became runners-up in the West Zone tournament.

❖ Under 14 category:

- Vasudev Parikot : 8th grade - National

❖ Under 17 category:

- Pavitra Shanmugam : 10th grade - Tamil Nadu state
- Aishwarya Mappat : 9th grade - Tamil Nadu state
- S.S. Dhiaan : 10th grade - Tamil Nadu state



❖ Under 19 category:

- Anjali Nambiar : 11th grade - Tamil Nadu state

Swimming Team: Our school's swimming team is headed by Sushmit Sir and Geeta Maam. We have excellent facilities, excellent swimmers, and a dedicated teacher. Our highly motivated team has reached the Nationals many times.

❖ Under 14 category: All reached National level

- Uma Arora : 8th grade
- Narmada Udaykumar : 8th grade
- Pooja Harjani : 8th grade
- Shreya Gupta : 7th grade
- Anisha Saiganesh : 7th grade

❖ Under 19 category: National level

- Aishwarya Mappat : 9th grade
- Dhruva Madhavan : 9th grade
- Pritham Velamur : 9th grade
- S. Goutham : 9th grade
- Rohit Sharma : IB 1st year
- Harsh Tibrewal : IB 1st year
- Vineet Desai : IB 1st year
- Ankit Tibrewal : IB 1st year



Basketball Team: Once again, our Prakash Coach heads this team as well, pouring talent onto the court. This team also received the position of runners-up in the West Zone tournament. With the basketball senior girls category, we reached the Coimbatore District Level.

SPORTS ACHIEVERS OF CIRS



❖ Under 14 category:

- Aishwarya Sindhav : 8th grade - Tamil Nadu state

Hockey Team: Our Srinivasan Coach is the head of our excellent team, who were also runners-up in the tournament for the West Zone.

❖ Under 14 category: Coimbatore District Level

- Shray Saboo : 6th grade
- Ashwin Kumar : 7th grade
- Senthil Raj : 8th grade

❖ Under 19 category:

- Bhishma R. : 11th grade
- Prachi Kabra : 11th grade



Badminton and Table Tennis: Both these teams are headed by the dynamic Siva Sir and Kaushiki Maam. We've reached not only district tournaments, but also zonal level

Table Tennis:

❖ Under 19 category:

- Jenil Gogri : 11th grade - Zonal

Badminton:

❖ Under 17 category:

- Lakshmi Sneha : 10th grade - District
- Nandhitha : 10th grade - District



Tennis: Siva_Shanmugam Sir heads the tennis team as well, leading our students to exceptional performances.

- Devika Choudhary : 11th grade : CBSE National Team,
Tamil Nadu State Team,
Madhya Pradesh State Team

Cricket: Our cricket team is lead by Durai Rajan sir. Our team has done excellently well and we are on our way to reach the Nationals.

- Soham Desai: 12th grade:

Under 17 Gujrat State Team
Under 19 Gujrat State Team

Regulars



1. Campus News:

- We began the term with the auspicious Gaythri Homa invoking the blessings of divinity.
- Addition to the family:
 - In order to meet the increased student population, a new family has joined the school, Mr. Sanjay Sabarwal in the Mathematics Department and his wife, Mrs Anju Sabarwal in the English Department.
 - Their two sons, have also enrolled as students in eighth and seventh standards respectively.
- An elephant broke into the campus on the night of January 20th. Luckily, it did not proceed past the dhobi tower, and those in the Mukundalaya (senior boys' dorm) had a good view of the whole event. Our ever courageous staff members managed to drive the elephant off, only to find one more waiting in the forest just outside the campus. Both elephants were sent back to the forest, and no elephant activity has taken place at our school since then.

2. Teacher and Student Talks:

- Teacher Talks:
 - Andavar Sir: Our mathematics teacher spoke on the “Power of Inspiration and the Mind.” He gave us inspiring examples of two we can use the power of our mind to lift ourselves to unbelievable heights in life.
 - Diwakar Sir: Our beloved Sir spoke on the “Seven Steps for Success,” and gave us practical methods through which we also can become successful in whatever Endeavors we undertake.
- Student Talks:
 - Kritika Kaul-9th grade:

She gave a thought-provoking talk on women, and how they are undervalued in today's society. She gave some excellent examples of how women can be as, if not more successful than, men in all aspects of life.
 - Saurabh Bhandari-11th grade:

He spoke on misconceptions and how they happen, and he cleared many of our misconceptions on the idea.

